

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 2-3 · with clues

Name _____

Date _____

Use the clues. Change **one letter** each step to make the word that matches the clue.

Ladder 1

M I L E

Start here

1

A white drink that comes from cows

2

Shiny cloth woven from a caterpillar's thread

3

Where you wash your hands

4

To make music with your voice

S O N G

Finish here

Ladder 2

C O O L

Start here

1

To make food hot and ready to eat

2

You can hang your coat on it

3

The part of a coat that covers your head

4

To keep something in your hands

S O L D

Finish here

Ladder 3

F I N E

Start here

1

The number after eight

2

Not even one

3

You smell with it

4

The opposite of win

L O S T

Finish here

Word Ladders

Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

M I L E

Start here

1 M I L K

A white drink that comes from cows

2 S I L K

Shiny cloth woven from a caterpillar's thread

3 S I N K

Where you wash your hands

4 S I N G

To make music with your voice

S O N G

Finish here

Ladder 2

C O O L

Start here

1 C O O K

To make food hot and ready to eat

2 H O O K

You can hang your coat on it

3 H O O D

The part of a coat that covers your head

4 H O L D

To keep something in your hands

S O L D

Finish here

Ladder 3

F I N E

Start here

1 N I N E

The number after eight

2 N O N E

Not even one

3 N O S E

You smell with it

4 L O S E

The opposite of win

L O S T

Finish here